

the purl code cardigan by Isabell Kraemer



the purl code cardigan© 2020

a handknit design by Isabell Kraemer/grasflecken.

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For pattern support (in English), please contact

grasfleckenbylilalu@gmail.com

Yarn

Leading Men Fiber Arts, Soliloquy [657 yds (601 m)/150g], *shown in color rusted*

2 (2, 3, 3, 3)(3, 3, 4, 4) skeins or approximately 1116 (1229, 1368, 1510, 1630)(1772, 1887, 2018, 2133) yds/ 1020 (1123, 1250, 1380, 1490)(1620, 1725, 1845, 1950) m

Needles

US 2 1/2 (3 mm) 32" (80 cm) circular needle and DPNs (or longer circular needle for magic loop) for cast on, body ribbing, button bands and sleeve ribbing.

US 3 (3.25 mm) 32" (80 cm) circular needle and DPNs (or longer circular needle for magic loop) for yoke, body and sleeves.

Gauge

26 sts x 38 rows = 4" (10 cm) square in Stockinette stitch on larger needle after blocking.

Sizes

1 (2, 3, 4, 5)(6, 7, 8, 9)

finished bust circumference:

37 (40, 43, 46, 49.25)(53.5, 57.25, 61.5, 65.25)"
92.5 (100, 107.5, 115.5, 123)(134, 143, 154, 163) cm

Suggested ease: 2 - 6" (5 - 15 cm)

Sample is worn with approximately 4" (10 cm) positive ease at bust (see schematic on the last page for more measurements).

Materials

Stitch holders or waste yarn, stitch markers, 10 buttons (or more if you like) [0.5" (1.3 cm) diameter], tapestry needle, blocking tools.

Special techniques and tips

German short rows: see this tutorial for some close-up photos:

http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=i_6PjI20zKA

On a RS row: Knit the number of stitches as stated in the pattern, turn work, bring yarn to front, slip the first stitch as if to purl, bring yarn over the needle to the back of your work and pull tight (this creates the double stitch = DS).

On a WS row: Purl the number of stitches as stated in the pattern, turn work, bring yarn to front, slip the first stitch as if to purl, bring yarn over the needle to the back of your work and pull tight (this creates the double stitch = DS).

Resolving double stitches: When working over double stitches treat them as a single stitch by knitting through both legs of the DS on a RS row (kDS) or purling through both legs of the DS on a WS row (pDS).

Backwards loop cast on method:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=goOVkdgvs>

Abbreviations

BO: bind off

BOR: beginning of the round

circ: circumference

CO: cast on

dec: decrease

DS: double stitch (see German short rows)

inc: increase

k: knit

k2tog: knit 2 stitches together

kDS: knit through both legs of the DS as one (see German short rows)

LH: left hand

m: marker

M1L: make one left (left leaning increase)

lift loop between stitches from front, knit (purl) into back loop

M1R: make one right (right leaning increase)

lift loop between stitches from back, knit (purl) into front loop

p: purl

p2tog: purl 2 stitches together (decrease)

pDS: purl through both legs of the DS as one (see German short rows)

pm: place marker

RH: right hand

Rnd(s): round(s)

RS: right side

sl m: slip marker

ssk: slip 2 stitches, one at a time, knitwise to the RH needle; return stitches to the LH needle in turned position and knit them together through the back loops (left leaning decrease)

ssp: slip 2 stitches, one at a time, knitwise to the RH needle; return stitches to LH needle in turned position and purl them together through the back loops (left leaning decrease)

st(s): stitch(es)

WS: wrong side

yo: yarn over

the purl code cardigan is worked seamlessly back and forth from the top down. First some short rows are worked to shape the neck. Raglan increases are then worked to final yoke depth (yoke is designed to be rather deep in relation to what you may be used to), where sleeve stitches are placed on hold. From this point the body is worked back and forth to the hem. Button bands are worked next. Then sleeve stitches are picked up again to work the sleeves in rounds top down to the cuffs. Purl stitch lines are added every now and then throughout (add purl stitches where you like/when you like/as many as you like) ...you may like the idea of using the [morse code alphabet](#) (see 'purl code alphabet' on the last page) for making this a statement sweater ;)

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Yoke

With US 2 1/2 (3 mm) needle, CO 110 (118, 118, 122, 130)(130, 130, 134, 138) sts using your preferred method.

Change to US 3 (3.25 mm) needle.

Place markers for raglan increases

Next row (WS): K18 (20, 20, 21, 22)(22, 22, 22, 23), pm, k21 (21, 21, 21, 23)(23, 23, 25, 25), pm, k33 (37, 37, 39, 41)(41, 41, 41, 43), pm, k21 (21, 21, 21, 23)(23, 23, 25, 25), pm, k17 (19, 19, 20, 21)(21, 21, 21, 22).

Sizes 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Continue to *Short row shaping*.

Sizes 6, 7

Next row (RS) (inc row): K3, M1L, (k4, M1L) 4 times, knit to m, sl m, p1, k3, M1L, (k5, M1L) 3 times, knit to m, sl m, p1, k2, M1L, (k4, M1L) 9 times, knit to m, sl m, p1, k3, M1L, (k5, M1L) 3 times, knit to m, sl m, p1, k2, M1L (k4, M1L) 4 times, knit to end. (28 sts inc'd)
- (-, -, -, -)(51, 51, -, -) sts for back, - (-, -, -, -)(27, 27, -, -) sts for each sleeve, - (-, -, -, -)(27, 27, -, -) sts for right front, - (-, -, -, -)(26, 26, -, -) sts for left front

Next row (WS): Work all stitches as they appear. Continue to *Short row shaping*.

Size 8

Next row (RS) (inc row): K3, M1L, (k4, M1L) 4 times, knit to m, sl m, p1, (k5, M1L) 4 times, knit to m, sl m, p1, k2, M1L, (k4, M1L) 9 times, knit to m, sl m, p1, (k5, M1L) 4 times, knit to m, sl m, p1, k2, M1L (k4, M1L) 4 times, knit to end. (28 sts *inc'd*)

51 sts for back, 29 sts for each sleeve, 27 sts for right front, 26 sts for left front

Next row (WS): Work all stitches as they appear. Continue to *Short row shaping*.

Size 9

Next row (RS) (inc row): K3, M1L, (k4, M1L) 4 times, knit to m, sl m, p1, (k5, M1L) 4 times, knit to m, sl m, p1, k3, M1L (k4, M1L) 9 times, knit to m, sl m, p1, (k5, M1L) 4 times, knit to m, sl m, p1, k3, M1L, (k4, M1L) 4 times, knit to end. (28 sts inc'd)

53 sts for back, 29 sts for each sleeve, 28 sts for right front, 27 sts for left front

Next row (WS): Work all stitches as they appear. Continue to *Short row shaping*.

Short row shaping

Short row 1 (inc for left front, back and sleeves): (RS) Knit to 1 stitch before m, M1R, k1, sl m, p1, knit to 1 stitch before next m, M1R, k1, sl m, p1, k1, M1L, knit to 1 stitch before next m, M1R, k1, sl m, p1, k1, M1L, knit to 3 sts before next m, turn; **(WS)** DS, work all stitches as they appear to 4 sts before last marker, turn. (5 sts *inc'd*)

35 (39, 39, 41, 43)(53, 53, 53, 55) sts for back, 22
(22, 22, 22, 24)(28, 28, 30, 30) sts for each
sleeve, 18 (20, 20, 21, 22)(27, 27, 27, 28) sts for
fronts

Short row 2 (inc for back and sleeves): (RS)

DS, knit to 1 stitch before m, M1R, k1, sl m, p1, k1, M1L, knit to 1 stitch before next m, M1R, k1, sl m, p1, k1, M1L, knit to DS, kDS, k2, turn; **(WS)** DS, work all stitches as they appear to DS, pDS, p2, turn. (4 sts inc'd)

37 (41, 41, 43, 45)(55, 55, 55, 57) sts for back, 23
(23, 23, 23, 25)(29, 29, 31, 31) sts for each
sleeve, 18 (20, 20, 21, 22)(27, 27, 27, 28) sts for
each front

Short row 3 (inc for back and right front): (RS)

DS, knit to m, sl m, p1, k1, M1L, knit to 1 stitch before next m, M1R, k1, sl m, p1, knit to DS, kDS, knit to m, sl m, p1, k1, M1L, k1, turn; **(WS)** DS, work all stitches as they appear to DS, pDS, purl to 1 stitch before m, k1, sl m, p3, turn. (3 sts inc'd)
39 (43, 43, 45, 47)(57, 57, 57, 59) sts for back, 23 (23, 23, 23, 25)(29, 29, 31, 31) sts for each sleeve, 19 (21, 21, 22, 23)(28, 28, 28, 29) sts for right front, 18 (20, 20, 21, 22)(27, 27, 27, 28) sts for left front

Note: Feel free to start adding purl lines every now and then. The pattern will not mention these purl lines, it's up to you where and when you add them (see last page for purl code alphabet).

[illegible]

Short row 4 (inc for body and sleeves):

(RS) DS, (knit to 1 stitch before m, M1R, k1, sl m, p1, k1, M1L) 4 times, knit to DS, kDS, k3, turn;
(WS) DS, work all stitches as they appear to DS, pDS, p3, turn. (8 sts inc'd)

41 (45, 45, 47, 49)(59, 59, 59, 61) sts for back, 25
(25, 25, 25, 27)(31, 31, 33, 33) sts for each
sleeve, 20 (22, 22, 23, 24)(29, 29, 29, 30) sts for
right front, 19 (21, 21, 22, 23)(28, 28, 28, 29) sts
for left front

Short row 5 (inc for body): (RS) DS, (knit to 1 stitch before m, M1R, k1, sl m, p1, knit to next m, sl m, p1, k1, M1L) 2 times, knit to DS, kDS, k4, turn; **(WS)** DS, work all stitches as they appear to DS, pDS, p4, turn. (4 sts inc'd)

43 (47, 47, 49, 51)(61, 61, 61, 63) sts for back, 25 (25, 25, 25, 27)(31, 31, 33, 33) sts for each sleeve, 21 (23, 23, 24, 25)(30, 30, 30, 31) sts for right front, 20 (22, 22, 23, 24)(29, 29, 29, 30) sts for left front

Next row (RS) (inc for body and sleeves): DS, (knit to 1 stitch before m, M1R, k1, sl m, p1, k1, M1L) 4 times, knit to DS, kDS, knit to end. (8 sts inc'd)

45 (49, 49, 51, 53)(63, 63, 63, 65) sts for back, 27 (27, 27, 27, 29)(33, 33, 35, 35) sts for each sleeve, 22 (24, 24, 25, 26)(31, 31, 31, 32) sts for right front, 21 (23, 23, 24, 25)(30, 30, 30, 31) sts for left front

Next row (WS): Work all stitches as they appear to end (pDS when you reach it).

Raglan increases

Row 1 (RS) (inc for body): (Knit to 1 stitch before m, M1R, k1, sl m, p1, knit to next m, sl m, p1, k1, M1L) 2 times, knit to end. (4 sts inc'd)

Row 2 (WS): Work all stitches as they appear.

Row 3 (RS) (inc for body and sleeves): (Knit to 1 stitch before m, M1R, k1, sl m, p1, k1, M1L) 4 times, knit to end. (8 sts inc'd)

Row 4 (WS): Work all stitches as they appear. 49 (53, 53, 55, 57)(67, 67, 67, 69) sts for back, 29 (29, 29, 29, 31)(35, 35, 37, 37) sts for each sleeve, 24 (26, 26, 27, 28)(33, 33, 33, 34) sts for right front, 23 (25, 25, 26, 27)(32, 32, 32, 33) sts for left front

Repeat **rows 1 - 4** 11 (13, 15, 16, 19)(20, 23, 25, 27) more times.

93 (105, 113, 119, 133)(147, 159, 167, 177) sts for back, 51 (55, 59, 61, 69)(75, 81, 87, 91) sts for each sleeve, 46 (52, 56, 59, 66)(73, 79, 83, 88) sts for right front, 45 (51, 55, 58, 65)(72, 78, 82, 87) sts for left front

Sizes 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7

Repeat **rows 3 + 4** 4 (3, 3, 4, 2)(1, 1, -, -) more time(s).

101 (111, 119, 127, 137)(149, 161, -, -) sts for back, 59 (61, 65, 69, 73)(77, 83, -, -) sts for each sleeve, 50 (55, 59, 63, 68)(74, 80, -, -) sts for right front, 49 (54, 58, 62, 67)(73, 79, -, -) sts for left front

Continue to *Separate body and sleeves*.

Size 8, 9

Row 1 (RS) (inc for body): (Knit to 1 stitch before m, M1R, k1, sl m, p1, knit to next m, sl m, p1, k1, M1L) 2 times, knit to end. (4 sts inc'd)

Row 2 (WS) (inc for body): Purl to 2 sts before m, M1L (purl), p1, k1, sl m, purl to 1 stitch before next m, k1, sl m, p1, M1R (purl), purl to 2 sts before m, M1L (purl), p1, k1, sl m, purl to 1 stitch before m, k1, sl m, p1, M1R (purl), purl to end. (4 sts inc'd)

Repeat **row 1** one more time, then work a WS row without increases.

- (-, -, -, -)(-, -, 173, 183) sts for back, - (-, -, -, -)(-, -, 87, 91) sts for each sleeve, - (-, -, -, -)(-, -, 86, 91) sts for right front, - (-, -, -, -)(-, -, 85, 90) sts for left front

Continue to *Separate body and sleeves*.

Separate body and sleeves

Next row (RS): Knit to m, remove m, **k1**, slip following 58 (60, 64, 68, 72)(76, 82, 86, 90) sts on waste yarn for left sleeve, remove m, using the backwards loop method (or your preferred method) to CO 9 (9, 10, 11, 11)(12, 12, 13, 14) sts, pm (for side), CO 9 (9, 10, 11, 11)(12, 12, 13, 14) sts, **k1**, knit to next m, remove m, **k1**, slip following 58 (60, 64, 68, 72)(76, 82, 86, 90) sts on waste yarn for right sleeve, remove m, using the backwards loop method (or your preferred method) to CO 9 (9, 10, 11, 11)(12, 12, 13, 14) sts, pm (for side), CO 9 (9, 10, 11, 11)(12, 12, 13, 14) sts, **k1**, knit to end. 120 (130, 140, 150, 160)(174, 186, 200, 212) sts for back, 59 (64, 69, 74, 79)(86, 92, 99, 105) sts for each front

Next row (WS): Purl to m, sl m, k1, purl to 1 stitch before next m, k1, sl m, purl to end.

Body

Row 1 (RS): Knit to m, sl m, p1, knit to 1 stitch before next m, p1, sl m, knit to end.

Row 2 (WS): Purl to m, sl m, k1, purl to 1 stitch before next m, k1, sl m, purl to end.

Continue working **rows 1 + 2** until body measures approximately 12.5" (32 cm) or 2.25" (5.5 cm) less than desired length from underarm, ending after a WS row.

Ribbing

Change to US 2 1/2 (3 mm) needle.

Next row (RS): K1 (2, 1, 2, 1)(2, 2, 1, 1), (p1, k1) to m, remove m, (p1, k1) to 1 stitch before next m, M1R, p1, remove m, (k1, p1) to last 1 (2, 1, 2, 1)(2, 2, 1, 1) stitch(es), knit to end. (1 stitch inc'd)

Next row (WS): Work all stitches as they appear.

Continue working in ribbing as set until ribbing measures approximately 2" (5 cm), ending after a RS row.

Next row (WS): Purl to end.

Bind off all stitches knitwise. Do not break yarn, leave last stitch on RH needle.

Buttonhole band

With US 2 1/2 (3 mm) needle, pick up and knit 3 sts out of 4 rows from right front edge.

Next row (WS): Purl to end.

On next row, work buttonholes.

Place one removable marker approximately 0.5" (1 cm) from neck edge, place another removable marker approximately 0.75" (2 cm) from lower edge, place 8 (or the number of buttons you planned minus 2) additional markers evenly spaced between them.

Next row (RS) (buttonhole row): (Knit to m, remove m, yo, k2tog) 10 times, knit to end.

Next row (WS): Purl to end.

Next row (RS): Knit to end

Next row (WS): Knit to end.

BO all stitches knitwise.

Button band

With US 2 1/2 (3 mm) needle, RS of cardigan facing, beg at the neck edge of left front, pick up and knit 3 sts out of 4 rows. Make sure to pick up the same number of stitches as for the buttonhole band.

Next row (WS): Purl to end.

Next row (RS): Knit to end.

Repeat last 2 rows one more time.

Next row (WS): Knit to end.

BO all stitches knitwise.



Neck finishing (optional)

With US 2 1/2 (3 mm) needle, RS of cardigan facing, beg at the neck edge of the right front, pick up and knit 2 sts out of 3 rows from buttonhole band, every stitch from neck CO, 2 sts out of 3 rows from button band.

Next row (WS): P1, ssk, knit to 3 sts before end, k2tog, p1.

Next row (RS): K1, ssk, knit to 3 sts before end, k2tog, k1.

Next row (WS): P1, p2tog, purl to 3 sts before end, ssp, p1.

BO all stitches knitwise.

Sleeves

Place 58 (60, 64, 68, 72)(76, 82, 86, 90) sleeve stitches on US 3 (3.25 mm) DPNs (or longer circular needle for magic loop), beginning at the center of underarm, pick up and knit 9 (9, 10, 11, 11)(12, 12, 13, 14) sts, knit across sleeve stitches, pick up and knit 9 (9, 10, 11, 11)(12, 12, 13, 14) sts, pm for BOR and join to knit in the round. Distribute stitches so that the first stitch of the round lines up with the purl stitch of the body. 76 (78, 84, 90, 94)(100, 106, 112, 118) sts for sleeve

Next rnd: P1, knit to end.

Work in Stockinette stitch in the round with purled seam stitch until sleeve measures approximately 2" (5 cm) from underarm.

Dec rnd: Sl m, p1, k1, k2tog, knit to last 3 sts, ssk, k1. (2 sts dec'd)

74 (76, 82, 88, 92)(98, 104, 110, 116) sts

Repeat **dec rnd** every 13 (13, 10, 9, 8)(7, 6, 5, 5) rounds 5 (5, 6, 2, 3)(9, 11, 22, 19) more times, then every 12 (12, 9, 8, 7)(6, 5, 4, 4) rounds, 4 (4, 6, 12, 13)(9, 10, 2, 7) more times.

56 (58, 58, 60, 60)(62, 62, 62, 64) sts

Once all decreases are done, work in Stockinette stitch in rounds with purled seam stitch until sleeve measures 15.75" (40 cm) or 2.25" (5.5 cm) less than desired length.

Ribbing

Change to US 2 1/2 (3 mm) needle.

Next rnd: Sl m, (p1, k1) to end.

Rep last rnd for ribbing.

When ribbing measures 2" (5 cm), knit 1 round and BO all stitches knitwise.

Repeat instructions for second sleeve.

Finishing

Block sweater to measurements and weave in ends. Sew on buttons according to the button-holes.

Schematic



Measurements in inches

Bust circ (closed): 37 (40, 43, 46, 49.25)(53.5, 57.25, 61.5, 65.25)
Yoke depth (back neck to underarm): 7.25 (8, 8.75, 9.5, 10.25)(10.75, 12, 13, 13.75)
Upper arm circ: 11.75 (12, 13, 13.75, 14.5)(15.5, 16.25, 17.25, 18.25)
Sleeve length from underarm: +/- 18
Body length from underarm: +/- 14.75

Measurements in cm

Bust circ (closed): 92.5 (100, 107.5, 115.5, 123)(134, 143, 154, 163)
Yoke depth (back neck to underarm): 18.5 (20, 22, 23.5, 25.5)(26.5, 29.5, 32.5, 34.5)
Upper arm circ: 29 (30, 32.5, 34.5, 36)(38.5, 41, 43, 45.5)
Sleeve length from underarm: +/- 45.5
Body length from underarm: +/- 37.5

Purl code alphabet

To separate letters, work 3 knit stitches; to separate words, work 7 knit stitches. Please allow at least one plain row between each 'purl code' row to make them more visible. In brackets you see the number of stitches each letter takes.

A (5): p1, k1, p3
B (9): p3, k1, p1, k1, p1, k1, p1
C (11): p3, k1, p1, k1, p3, k1, p1
D (7): p3, k1, p1, k1, p1
E (1): p1
F (9): p1, k1, p1, k1, p3, k1, p1
G (9): p3, k1, p3, k1, p1
H (7): p1, k1, p1, k1, p1, k1, p1
I (3): p1, k1, p1
J (13): p1, k1, p3, k1, p3, k1, p3
K (9): p3, k1, p1, k1, p3
L (9): p1, k1, p3, k1, p1, k1, p1
M (7): p3, k1, p3

N (5): p3, k1, p1
O (11): p3, k1, p3, k1, p3
P (11): p1, k1, p3, k1, p3, k1, p1
Q (13): p3, k1, p3, k1, p1, k1, p3
R (7): p1, k1, p3, k1, p1
S (5): p1, k1, p1, k1, p1
T (3): p3
U (7): p1, k1, p1, k1, p3
V (9): p1, k1, p1, k1, p1, k1, p3
W (9): p1, k1, p3, k1, p3
X (11): p3, k1, p1, k1, p1, k1, p3
Y (13): p3, k1, p1, k1, p3, k1, p3
Z (11): p3, k1, p3, k1, p1, k1, p1